



7th Grade English Language Arts

M/J Language Arts 2 (Florida course 1001040) · Full year, delivered as two semester sections · Six works of fiction, read daily and written about all year

~4¼ hrs
per week
50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More books are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in texts and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions, so the week-to-week experience varies; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Over the year your scholar reads six works of fiction: a satirical voyage among giants and tiny emperors, the first great science-fiction novel, a Christmas ghost story, a modern novel of loyalty between brothers, a classic suspense short story, and an adventure of disguise set during the French Revolution. The daily work is steady and concrete. Scholars read a portion of the current book each day (linked right on the lesson page, with audio support), respond in writing to what they read, keep up a weekly vocabulary practice of their choosing, and complete short grammar lessons with quick self-check quizzes. Each novel builds toward a final essay, written step by step (thesis, evidence, counterargument, conclusion), paired with a creative project. VR activities bring scenes, characters, and ideas from the reading into Optima's immersive campus each week.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE — 6 MODULES · 34 WEEKS

Module · Text	Weeks	Quarter	Focus & module projects
Welcome Week	1	Q1	Getting set up: navigating the Canvas course and practicing how lessons work
1 · <i>Gulliver's Travels</i> — Jonathan Swift	8	Q1–Q2	Satire, narrative point of view, parts of speech; final project with written and creative components
2 · <i>Frankenstein</i> — Mary Shelley	6	Q2	Argumentative writing taught step by step (thesis, evidence, conclusion); figurative language, suspense, tone; final essay + creative project
3 · <i>A Christmas Carol</i> — Charles Dickens	2	Q2	Theme, symbolism, Scrooge's turning point, comparing text and film in VR
4 · <i>The Outsiders</i> — S. E. Hinton	7	Q3	Theme, character development, annotation, "Nothing Gold Can Stay"; final essay + creative project
5 · "The Most Dangerous Game" — Richard Connell	1	Q3	Irony and annotation in a single intensive short-story week
6 · <i>The Scarlet Pimpernel</i> — Baroness Orczy	9	Q4	Historical context, characterization, suspense; a guided outline week (thesis, evidence, counterargument), then the final essay + creative component

A TYPICAL WEEK — FIVE LESSON DAYS

When	What the scholar does (~50 min/day)
Weekly	Vocabulary Choice Board: the scholar picks how to practice the week's words, plus a Module Map showing the week ahead.
Mon–Thu	Each day pairs the day's reading (linked on the page) with a literature lesson and a written Read + Respond or a short reading-check quiz.
Mon–Thu	Most days also include a brief grammar lesson with a quick "Grammar POP!" or "Grammar Build" check; a Quick Write and one or two VR activities land here too.
Fri	Friday Check-up: a short quiz on the week's reading. Project submissions also land on Fridays.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week is the school's designated planning figure for this course: five lessons of about 50 minutes, Monday through Friday. The day's reading and its written response are the core of that time; grammar, vocabulary, and VR activities fill out the rest. **Final-project weeks** (essays and creative projects) can run longer, and slower readers should budget extra reading time for the novels.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- ▶ A computer with a web browser; all readings are provided on the lesson pages, with **audio versions** to read along with for major texts
- ▶ **VR headset** for Optima's VR campus, used for weekly literature activities such as setting the scene, character work, and close reading
- ▶ Writing materials for notes and vocabulary practice

GRADING AT A GLANCE

Category	Weight	Includes
Asynchronous Homework & Quizzes	60%	Read + Respond, grammar checks, vocabulary boards, Friday Check-ups
Essays, Tests, Projects	30%	Module final essays, creative projects, outlines
Synchronous Activities	10%	Office hours and live VR experiences

SHARED & LIVE OPPORTUNITIES

- ▶ A standing **Office Hours and Live VR Experiences** module connects scholars with their teacher and classmates
- ▶ Weekly **announcement videos** from the teacher open most weeks
- ▶ Discussion boards and **recorded spoken responses** give scholars an audience beyond the page

NOTES FOR FAMILIES

On-Demand (asynchronous). This course is designed for self-paced study: lessons follow a clear daily numbering and weekly rhythm, with due dates for pacing. A teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Scholars enrolled in the live school complete the same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.